

1.3 Case Application: The Callum Coffee-Spill Scene

Use this worked example as a calibration reference when running your own audits. It demonstrates how a single flat output fails across all five dimensions simultaneously.

Scene: Grumpy hero Callum is working at a café. Sunshine heroine Mara spills coffee on his manuscript. The prompt specified "grumpy and guarded."

Flat AI Output:

"Oh, that's quite all right. I appreciate you being honest about it. Perhaps we can find a way to clean this up together. I understand these things happen."

Five-Dimensional Breakdown:

Dimension	What the AI Produced	What Callum Should Sound Like
Cadence	Uniform rhythm; four sentences at the same unhurried pace	Clipped fragments; abrupt stops; cuts Mara off mid-apology
Vocabulary Range	Polite, mid-register, collaborative ("I appreciate," "Perhaps," "Together")	Short, blunt monosyllables; hard consonants; language that closes doors
Sentence-Length Variance	All sentences 12–15 words; metronomic	Alternates between three-word snaps ("Great. Just great.") and one longer controlled sentence
Emotional Register	Warm, forgiving, collaborative	Cold, controlled; irritation leaking through cracks like steam from a sealed lid
Conversational Rhythm	Waits for Mara to finish; responds fully; invites collaboration	Interrupts; deflects; shuts down the exchange; turns away while she is still mid-sentence

Key Insight: Typing "make him sound grumpier" addresses roughly 10% of the Emotional Register dimension and ignores the other four entirely. All five channels require independent correction.